

There is another aspect of modern optical drives that we haven't covered, and that is burning disks. We're sure you can imagine where having a virtual disk burner can come in quite handy.

DAEMON Tools, which we have just mentioned above, includes this feature in its more advanced paid editions. TotalMounter is a free of cost software that also offers the ability to burn to a virtual disk. In both these cases, data is instead written to an image file.

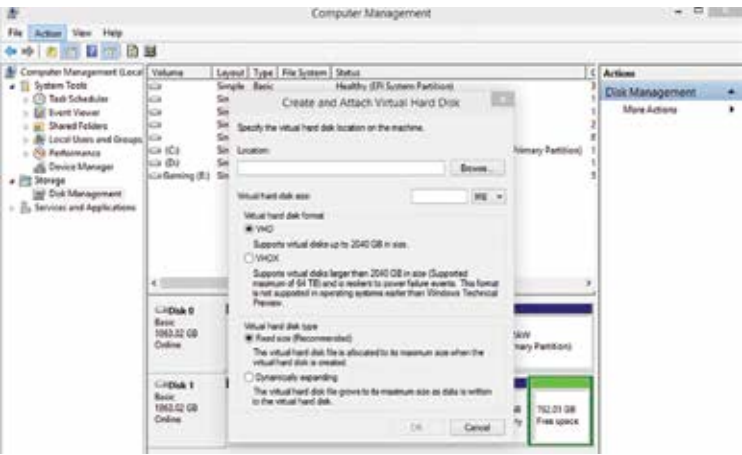
Storage Device Emulators

Since they all serve a similar purpose, we will use this category to talk about software the emulate all kinds of storage devices, hard drives, pendrives and — why not — floppy drives.

These are widely used in virtual machine software, in fact outside of a virtual machine there is probably never really a need to emulate a floppy drive. Any software that requires the presence of a floppy disk is unlikely to run directly on modern systems anyway.

Even if you aren't using a virtual machine to run another OS, virtual hard drives can be quite useful, and not just for developers. Virtual hard drives let you package up the contents of an entire hard disk into a single file making it easier to manage.

Native support for creating virtual hard drives in the VHD format has been present in Windows since Windows 7, and before that (XP



Creating a VHD file using the disk management tool in Windows.